

CARAMELLE WITH CARAMELIZED ONION, BROWN BUTTER, AND BALSAMIC

SERVES
6-8

TOTAL TIME
5 h plus the dough rest

INGREDIENTS

228 g	Country bread, torn into pieces
56 g	Olive oil, for the bread crumbs
10 g	Garlic
125 g	Olive oil, for the onions
60 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed, for the onions
1.8 kg	Yellow onions, thinly sliced
237 g	Water
2 sprigs	Rosemary, for the onions
2 sprigs	Thyme, for the onions
60 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated, for the filling
quantity not given	Salt
quantity not given	Black pepper
1 batch	Egg dough
150 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed, to finish
quantity not given	Aged balsamic vinegar
1 sprig	Rosemary, leaves picked, to garnish
2 sprigs	Thyme, leaves picked, to garnish
22 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated, to garnish

METHOD

- Heat the oven to 200°F.
- Spread the torn bread over a sheet pan and dry it out in the oven for 30 to 45 minutes. It should take no color at all. Crush a shard with the back of a spoon to check, the inside has to be bone dry. Let it cool.
- Pulse the cooled bread in a food processor down to fine crumbs, stopping while they still have some texture rather than turning to dust.
- Set a saute pan over medium-low heat with the 56 g olive oil and the garlic. Cook 1 to 2 minutes, until the garlic scents the oil, then lift the garlic out and keep it for another use.
- Drop the heat to low, add the crumbs and stir now and then until golden brown, 5 to 8 minutes. Drain them on a paper-towel-lined plate and let them cool.
- Weigh out 104 g of crumbs for the filling. The rest keeps in an airtight container somewhere cool and dry for a week.
- Warm the 125 g oil and the 60 g butter together in a large Dutch oven set over low heat, swirling them into each other.
- Add the onions and turn them so every slice carries the fat. Cook 10 to 15 minutes until soft and translucent, stirring occasionally so nothing catches.
- Pour in the water. Tie the 2 rosemary and 2 thyme sprigs into a bundle with kitchen twine and bury it in the pot.
- Lay a sheet of parchment directly on the onions and cook 2 to 3 hours, lifting the paper to stir from time to time, until they have collapsed completely and gone deep brown. By then the water should all have evaporated. Take the pot off the heat and let it cool.
- Blend the cooled onions smooth in a high-speed blender.
- Scrape the puree into a bowl, fold in the 104 g bread crumbs and the 60 g parmigiano, and season with salt and pepper. Cover and refrigerate until you shape the pasta.
- Make 80 to 100 caramelle from the egg dough and the filling.
- Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to the boil.
- In a small saucepan over medium heat, cook 85 g of the butter for 3 to 4 minutes, just past golden brown. Set it aside to drizzle over the plated pasta.
- Add the caramelle and pull the heat back so the water holds a gentle simmer rather than a boil. The filling is delicate and a hard boil will split it out. Give them 2 to 3 minutes, until the thickest closure point is tender.
- Meanwhile set a large saute pan over low heat with the remaining 65 g butter and 2 to 3 ladles of pasta water, 115 g to 170 g. Swirl to emulsify.
- Lift the pasta across with a spider, raise the heat to medium and swirl 30 seconds to 1 minute, turning the pieces with a spoon so all sides are coated. A splash more pasta water loosens the sauce if it tightens.
- Transfer to plates or a platter and spoon the pan sauce over, slackening it first with a little pasta water if it needs it. Drizzle with the balsamic and the reserved brown butter, then finish with the rosemary, thyme, parmigiano and pepper.

NOTES

The balsamic has to be an aged bottle with sweetness and some viscosity, not the thin kind you would whisk into a vinaigrette. It does not need to be twenty-five years old.

Bread crumbs and parmigiano are in the filling for binding and creaminess, not for flavor.

The crumb batch is deliberately larger than the filling needs. 104 g goes in, the surplus keeps a week.

The 150 g of finishing butter splits two ways: 85 g browned for drizzling, 65 g for the pan sauce.

Caramelle go into water at a bare simmer. A rolling boil breaks the filling out of the closures.

FILLING

Caramelized Onion and Parmigiano Filling

INGREDIENTS

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56 g	Olive oil, for the bread crumbs
10 g	Garlic
125 g	Olive oil, for the onions
60 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
1.8 kg	Yellow onions, thinly sliced
237 g	Water
2 sprigs	Rosemary
2 sprigs	Thyme
60 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
quantity not given	Salt
quantity not given	Black pepper

METHOD

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- Pulse the cooled bread in a food processor down to fine crumbs, stopping while they still have some texture rather than turning to dust.
- Set a saute pan over medium-low heat with the 56 g olive oil and the garlic. Cook 1 to 2 minutes, until the garlic scents the oil, then lift the garlic out and keep it for another use.
- Drop the heat to low, add the crumbs and stir now and then until golden brown, 5 to 8 minutes. Drain them on a paper-towel-lined plate and let them cool.
- Weigh out 104 g of crumbs for the filling. The rest keeps in an airtight container somewhere cool and dry for a week.
- Warm the 125 g oil and the butter together in a large Dutch oven set over low heat, swirling them into each other.
- Add the onions and turn them so every slice carries the fat. Cook 10 to 15 minutes until soft and translucent, stirring occasionally so nothing catches.
- Pour in the water. Tie the rosemary and thyme into a bundle with kitchen twine and bury it in the pot.
- Lay a sheet of parchment directly on the onions and cook 2 to 3 hours, lifting the paper to stir from time to time, until they have collapsed completely and gone deep brown. By then the water should all have evaporated. Take the pot off the heat and let it cool.
- Blend the cooled onions smooth in a high-speed blender.
- Scrape the puree into a bowl, fold in the 104 g bread crumbs and the parmigiano, and season with salt and pepper. Cover and refrigerate until you shape the pasta.

NOTES

Only 104 g of the crumbs goes into the filling. The batch is larger on purpose and the surplus keeps a week in an airtight container.

The crumbs and the parmigiano bind the onion puree and add creaminess to it.

Parchment laid straight onto the onions stops them drying out over the 2 to 3 hours it takes them to go deep brown.

Pulse the bread only as far as fine crumbs with some texture left. Dust will not bind.

SHAPE

Caramelle

Region: Emilia-Romagna, and widely made in the United States / Rest: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator

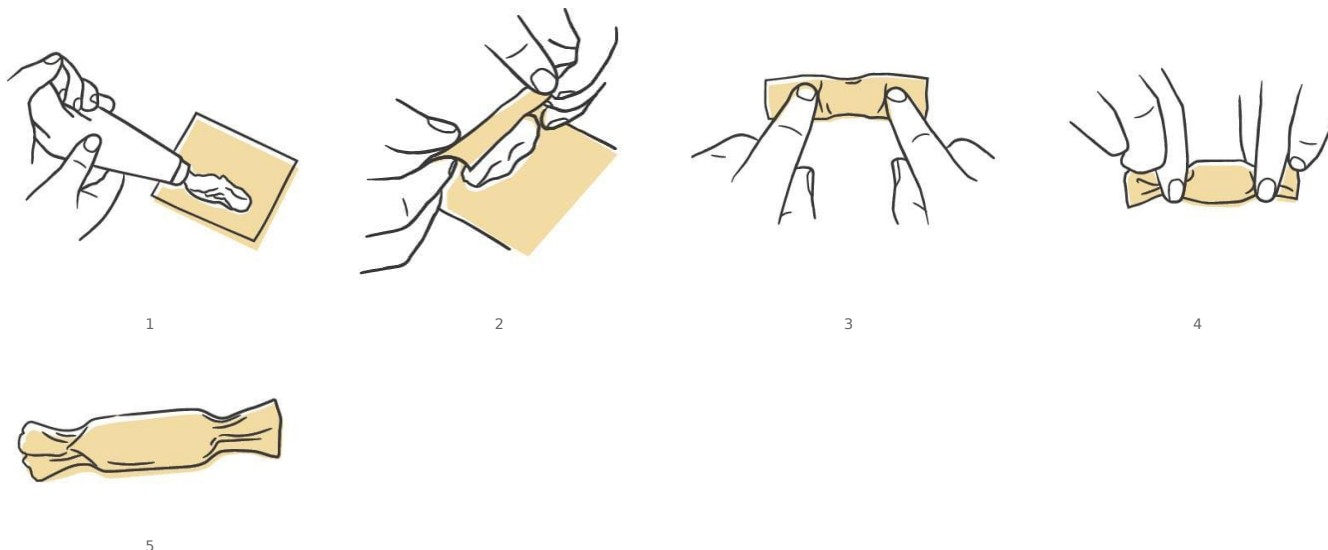
METHOD

- Make your chosen egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
- Dust a wooden board with 00 flour. Cover a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
- Lay one sheet on the board. Using a straight-edged dough divider, cut it into 2 1/2 by 3-inch rectangles. A plain pastry cutter with a ruler, or a knife with a ruler, works too. Keep the rectangles under plastic wrap or a towel.
- Load the filling into a pastry bag cut to a 1/2-inch opening. Pipe a rope of filling 1 1/2 inches long, sitting roughly 1/2 inch back from the wide (3-inch) bottom edge.
- Roll that bottom edge gently over the filling into a cylinder. Press down with an index finger at each end of the filling to seal the

dough, forcing the air out.

6. Pinch the closure on each side of the filling with thumb and index finger so it looks like a wrapped candy.
7. Set the piece on the prepared pan. Fill and roll the rest of the rectangles, keeping them in a single layer, and dust the pan again with semolina.
8. Repeat with the remaining sheets.
9. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

SHAPING



NOTES

Sheet is cut into 2 1/2 by 3-inch rectangles with a straight-edged dough divider, so the finished piece has plain, not fluted, ends.

Filling per piece: a rope 1 1/2 inches long, set 1/2 inch in from the 3-inch-wide edge, piped through a 1/2-inch opening. The rope is half the length of the edge it sits on, which leaves bare dough at each end for the pinched twists.

The 3-inch side is the bottom edge, so the roll axis runs along the long side of the rectangle.

Seal geometry: roll into a cylinder, press at each end of the filling with your index fingers to force out air, then pinch each end into a candy-wrapper twist. There is no braid and no fluted edge.

No misting step is called for. The book goes straight from piping the filling to rolling the cylinder.

Can be made long and thin, like a small Tootsie Roll, or shorter and fatter, like saltwater taffy.

Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.

Served with any sauce that will not hide the shape, such as a drizzle of balsamic or a plain butter sauce. With no traditional preparation of its own, it is used as freely as ravioli.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipó 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.

Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.

Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.

Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.